T/TH 9:30-10:45 I ICC 213

ENGL151 Sec.01

Jane Austen

GAY, DISABLED AUSTEN?

This course examines Jane Austen's contributions to the development of the English novel, including her popularization of free indirect discourse and use of the marriage plot. Alongside this textual focus, we will also read contemporary discourse around physical bodies, specifically, disability studies and queer theory. Finally, we will frame these literary and material innovations within the major social and political issues of late-eighteenth- and early-nineteenth-century Britain, including the Napoleonic wars, the abolition of the slave trade, and gender inequity in property laws and customs. In exploring Austen's textual and material deviations in conjunction with her political conservatism, this class hopes to complicate questions of who can love whom, when, and how.

INSTRUCTOR INFORMATION

LINDSEY E. R. O'NEIL

Office Hours T/TH 10:45am-noon (New North 335) & by appointment (Zoom)

Think of my office hours as an extension of the classroom. I am happy to discuss any aspect of your writing or reading, as well as any questions you may have about class procedures or requirements. You may "stop in" my [Zoom] office whenever you like. I ask that you give me at least 15 min to figure out where my laptop and Zoom login is when scheduling.

CLASS POLICIES

ATTENDANCE & PARTICIPATION: This class is primarily discussion based. You will be expected to come prepared to discuss the day's assigned text. **This means you should be contributing substantially to discussion in each class period.** You are also required to bring the assigned text to class on the day it is to be discussed. If you miss class for any reason, it will be **your responsibility** to find out what you missed and how you can make up the work from another student. Participation is a large part of your grade; act accordingly. More information on Georgetown's Attendance/Absence Policy can be found online.

LATE WORK & REVISION: Assignments are due on the date and time designated on the course syllabus. Extensions are accepted on professor's discretion and should be requested **before the due date.**

Likewise, revisions or rewrites of failing grades are accepted on professor's discretion and may only be requested prior to the next assignment.

PAPER FORMAT: Unless otherwise indicated, the standard format is:

- double-spaced throughout (with no extra spaces between paragraphs)
- Arial/Times New Roman/Calibri (12 point, no italics except for titles or emphasis)
- one-inch margins on all sides, left justified
- your name, my name, the section number for the course
- title of the paper center justified
- numbered pages

When you cite information, you should follow MLA style guidelines.

TECHNOLOGY: You may use a laptop or tablet for PDFs posted on ELMS. If these technologies become a distraction, I reserve the right to revoke this privilege. The first disruption will result in a warning; The second time your tech disrupts class, you will bring cookies in for the next class meeting. **Lack of attention due to technology will also be factored into your participation grade**.

COURSE CONTENT NOTE: Due to the nature of this course, we will be discussing historical events and texts that may be disturbing, even traumatizing, to some students. If you ever feel the need to step outside during one of these discussions, either for a short time or for the rest of the class session, you may always do so without academic penalty (You will, however, be responsible for any material you miss. If you do leave the room for a significant time, please make arrangements to get notes from another student or see me individually.)

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY: Plagiarism, whether it is submitting someone else's work as your own, submitting your own work completed for another class, or otherwise violating the University's code of Academic Integrity, will not be tolerated. Please contact me if you are uncertain of the definition of these academic violations and their potential consequences.

ACCESSIBILITY

Your success in the class is important to me. If there are circumstances that may affect your performance in this class, please let me know as soon as possible so that we can work together to develop strategies for adapting assignments to meet both your needs and the requirements of the course. If your name or pronouns need to be corrected, please let me know. If you have questions or concerns regarding physical, digital, or course accessibility, you may also contact arc@georgetown.edu or visit https://academicsupport.georgetown.edu/disability/.

COURSE SCHEDULE

WEEK 1 INTRODUCTIONS & FOUNDATIONS
TH JAN 12 Syllabus Day (feat. painful ice breakers).

WEEK 2 INTRO TO THEORY/MANSFIELD PARK (1814)
T JAN 17 Davis, "Introduction: Normality, Power, and Culture"; Farr, Intro to *Novel Bodies*. *MP* Ch. 1-3.
TH Jan 19 Presentations on Mary Wollstonecraft & *Rights of Woman* (1792) and George IV & Regency Masculinity; *MP* Ch. 4-5.

WEEK 3 MANSFIELD PARK (1814)
T JAN 24 Presentation on Edmund Burke, the Hastings Trial, and the Future of Empire (1788); Coleman, "Imagining Sameness and Difference"; *MP* Ch.6-12.
TH JAN 26 O'Quinn, "Jane Austen and Performance: Theatre, Memory, and Enculturation"; Butler, Selections from *Gender Trouble*; *MP* Ch. 13-16.

WEEK 4 MANSFIELD PARK (1814)
T JAN 31 Presentation on Slave Trade Act 1807 & British West Indies. *MP* Ch. 16-23.
TH FEB 2 Haggerty, "Fanny Price: 'Is she solemn?—Is she queer?—Is she prudish?'"; *MP* Ch. 24-28.

WEEK 5 MANSFIELD PARK (1814)
T FEB 7 Presentation on Royal Navy, Soldiers, Sailors, Veterans; *MP* Ch. 29-36.
TH FEB 9 *MP* Ch. 37- 42.

WEEK 6 MANSFIELD PARK (1814)
T FEB 14 Klein, "Fanny… Disabled Heroine"; *MP* Ch. 43-48.
TH FEB 16 PAPER I WORKSHOP

PAPER I DUE SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 19TH, AT 11:59PM.

WEEK 7 EMMA (1816)
T FEB 21 NO CLASS
TH FEB 23 Presentation on British Trade with the Far East - Tea, Porcelain, and Opium (1800s-10s); Schaffer, "Bodies Before the Normate"; *Emma* Vol. I, Ch. 1-6.

ASSIGNMENTS

PARTICIPATION: *25% of Final Grade* Active and repeated participation in class and group work. This includes bringing in questions, observations, passages that confused you, and so on. Texts and drafts should be brought on the days they are assigned.

CLASS PRESENTATION: *15% of Final Grade*. A short (<5 min) group presentation on a historical event/movement. Presentations should be both clear and engaging.

PAPER I: *15% of Final Grade*. A close thematic or symbolic examination of a text found on the syllabus. Due at 11:59pm of the day assigned. 2-3 pages.*

PAPER II: *20% of Final Grade*. A close thematic or symbolic examination of a text found on the syllabus. Due at 11:59pm of the day assigned. 3-4 pages.*

FINAL PAPER: *25% of Final Grade*. A culmination of the class with close readings *and* historical context of a text that has been pre-approved by the instructor. Due at 11:59pm of the day assigned. 5-7 pages.

*NOTE: Paper 1 or 2 may be swapped with an Unessay Project.

COURSE SCHEDULE

WEEK 8 EMMA (1816)
T FEB 28 Presentation on Saint-Domingue Revolution (1791) & Haitian Independence (1804); Moore, Intro to *Dangerous Intimacies*; *Emma* Vol. I, Ch. 7-12.
TH MARCH 2 Looser, "Jane Austen Camp"; *Emma* Vol. I, Ch. 13-18.

WEEK 9 SPRING BREAK!

WEEK 10 EMMA (1816)
T MARCH 14 Presentation on Year Without A Summer (1816); *Emma* Vol. II, Ch. 1-13.
TH MARCH 16 Washington, "Nonbinary Son"; *Emma* Vol. II, Ch. 14-18.

WEEK 11 EMMA (1816)
T MARCH 21 Presentation on Peterloo Massacre/Corn Laws (1819); *Emma* III. Ch. 1-5.
TH MARCH 23 Comyn, "Austen & Narrative Economics"; *Emma* III. Ch. 6-9.

WEEK 12 EMMA (1816)
T MARCH 28 Moore, "Desire and Diminution"; *Emma* III. Ch. 10-19.
TH MARCH 30 PAPER II WORKSHOP

PAPER II DUE SUNDAY, APRIL2ND, 11:59PM

WEEK 13 EASTER BREAK!
T APRIL 4 Asynchronous Online Class Project.
TH APRIL 6 Easter Break

WEEK 14 PERSUASION (1817)
T APRIL 11 Presentation on French Revolution 1789-99/Treaty of Amiens (1802); *P* Ch. 1-6.
TH APRIL 13 Quinn, "Sensation of Language"; *P* Ch. 7-10.

WEEK 15 PERSUASION (1817)
T APRIL 18 Presentation on Napoleonic Wars (after 1799); *P* Ch. 11-14.
TH APRIL 20 O'Farrell, "Mortifying Persuasions"; *P* Ch.15-18.

WEEK 16 PERSUASION (1817)
T APRIL 25 Presentations on Napoleon & Admiral Lord Nelson; *P* Ch. 19-21.
TH APRIL 27 Walle, "New Man of Feeling"; *P* Ch. 22-25.

WEEK 17 WORKSHOP
T MAY 2 FINAL PAPER WORKSHOP

FINAL PAPER DUE SUNDAY, MAY 7, AT 11:59PM